The CareLeaders

Programme brochure · 2026 to 27

nvr

Non Violent **Resistance**

NVR for your whole service: NVR Essentials for every member of staff, NVR Advanced for up to 12 champions, and a 90-day plan so it stays.

Children's homes | Fostering | Family support

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nvr

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Why we created it

most nvr training stops when the course ends.

Staff come back from a good day full of ideas. Then a hard week arrives, people move on, and practice drifts back to what it was. Services end up buying the same training every year.

When a young person's behaviour escalates, most staff are taught what to stop doing. NVR gives them something to do instead: stay calm, stay present, resist the behaviour without fighting the child, and repair the relationship afterwards. That only lasts if your own people can coach it and teach it.

that's why we built the nvr programme.

The question we start from

What do we do when it kicks off?

stay present. stay calm. come back.

Non-violent resistance was developed by Haim Omer to help parents respond to aggression without escalating it. We have adapted it for children's homes, fostering and family support.

What it is

NVR for your whole service, in three stages. Every member of staff learns the approach, up to 12 of your leaders become champions, and a 90-day plan keeps it going after we leave.



A seven-pillar health-check

Where your practice is strong, and where it drifts



NVR Essentials for everyone

6 hours face to face, or 2 hours live online



Up to 12 champions

NVR Advanced over about a term



A trainer pack

So champions can teach their own teams



A 90-day plan each

And an observed first session



A way to show impact

Agreed with you at the start

who it is for.

For	Children's homes, fostering and family support services
Stage 1	Every member of staff, up to 60 at a time
Stage 2	Up to 12 champions: team leaders, deputy and registered managers, practice leads and experienced carers
Commissioned by	Councils and providers

What it sets out to do

presence, not pressure.

Three objectives, for every service we work with.

practice.

The same response, whoever is on shift

Every member of staff using the same seven pillars.

Adults who stay calm and present when behaviour escalates.

Reconciliation practised, not just talked about.

leadership.

Champions in every home

Up to 12 champions who coach colleagues through the hardest moments.

Shared debrief and announcement routines.

Champions who train new staff themselves.

legacy.

NVR that stays

A 90-day plan for every champion.

A trainer pack and the NVR Toolkit you keep.

An agreed way to show what NVR is changing.

What children and young people get



Adults who stay, even when it is hard



The same approach from every adult on shift



Fewer escalations that end in restraint



Repair after conflict, every time



A team around them, not one adult alone

How it works

from a health-check to champions running it.

Every service is different, so we agree the dates and numbers with you at the start. NVR Essentials can also run on its own, for any team.

1	**Health-check**	Where your service is now: a seven-pillar health-check of your practice. We agree who trains and when, and you choose your champions.
2	**NVR Essentials**	Every member of staff learns the approach: 6 hours face to face, or 2 hours live online, up to 60 people at a time, timed around shift patterns.
3	**NVR Advanced**	Up to 12 champions learn to coach and to teach: three online sessions and three face-to-face days over about a term, working on a real case from your service.
4	**Champions deliver**	Each champion runs a session for their own team from the trainer pack. We observe and support their first co-delivery.
5	**Embed and evidence**	A 90-day plan for every champion, a champions network, and an agreed way to show impact, so NVR becomes how your service works.

nvr essentials.

One day that gives the whole team the same framework. Every part opens with a story from care, teaches the theory behind it and ends with a tool staff use on their next shift.

1



The NVR stance

Parental presence: why staying matters more than winning.

2



De-escalation

Staying calm in the hot moment, and baskets for choosing your battles.

3



Reconciliation and resistance

Repairing the relationship, and resisting the behaviour without fighting the child.

4



Leading it in your team

Supporters, self-care and what you will try on your next shift.

Face to face

6 hours, usually 10am to 4pm, for up to 60 people. A room set up for small-group work.

Live online

A 2-hour live session on Teams or Zoom covering the core of each part. The workbook and the NVR Toolkit carry the rest.

Every member of staff gets

A workbook, the recording, the NVR Toolkit on The Care Leaders Online for 12 months, and a certificate.

Stage 2 · up to 12 champions

nvr advanced.

Three blocks over about a term. Each opens with a 90-minute online session and ends with a face-to-face day, 10am to 3:30pm. Champions work on one real case from their own service all the way through, so every session is about their young people.

Block 1: Where you are

1 Online, 90 minutes

Meet the cohort, health-check your service against the seven pillars and choose a case to work on.

2 Face-to-face day

Parental presence, de-escalation and baskets on real situations. Practise cold-iron lines and the hot-moment protocol.

Block 2: Coaching

3 Online, 90 minutes

Review what happened with your team, then reconciliation and acts of resistance.

4 Face-to-face day

The pillars staff find hardest under pressure, how to coach colleagues through them, and debrief practice.

Block 3: Leading it

5 Online, 90 minutes

Bring your announcements and evidence, agree how your service will show impact, and plan your team session.

6 Face-to-face day

Announcements, sit-ins and facilitation. Rehearse the session you will deliver, and agree your 90-day plan.

Stage 3 · embed

nvr that stays.

The programme ends with your own people leading NVR, not with us leaving.

1 **A 90-day plan**
What each champion will do, with whom, and by when.

2 **A first session**
Each champion runs a session for their own team, with us observing the first one.

3 **A champions network**
Champions meet colleagues from other services to keep practice sharp.

What you keep

nothing we build stays ours.

With champions who coach and teach, your service can train new staff without us.

- **The NVR Toolkit.** Our online NVR course on The Care Leaders Online: foundations, parental presence and the seven pillars.
- **A seven-pillar health-check.** Where your practice is strong, and where it drifts.
- **The trainer pack.** Facilitator guide, slides, workbook and activities, so champions can deliver NVR to their own teams.
- **Champion routines.** Coaching prompts, and debrief and announcement templates.
- **A 90-day plan.** One for every champion, setting out what they will do and with whom.
- **A way to show impact.** Agreed with you, so you can evidence what NVR is changing.

Case study

Durham County Council

Children's Homes Service · September 2025 to 2026. NVR training, online modules and practice support.

120 residential staff trained

11 children's homes

2 online modules for every member of staff

2 face-to-face workshops, run morning and afternoon to fit shift patterns

less restraint, stronger relationships.

Durham Cares committed the council to reducing physical restraint. That meant giving residential staff something to do instead: a way to stay calm and present when a young person's behaviour escalates, and to repair the relationship afterwards. We designed the training around the realities of residential care and its rotas.

Online

Two modules on The Care Leaders Online: NVR principles, the seven pillars and preparation for the workshops.

Workshop 1

De-escalation and reconciliation gestures, run morning and afternoon so homes kept safe staffing.

Workshop 2

Acts of resistance and sit-ins.

What Durham runs now

Every member of staff keeps the online modules, and the approach sits inside Durham Cares, the vision the council owns.

What changed

Staff across the programme consistently reported feeling clearer, calmer and more connected in their practice.

Questions commissioners ask

what you might want to know.

Who is it for?

Children's homes, fostering and family support services that want NVR to become how the whole service responds when behaviour escalates, not a one-off training day.

Can we buy NVR Essentials on its own?

Yes. NVR Essentials runs as a standalone course for any team. The programme adds the champions stage and the 90-day plan, so the approach lasts.

Who should be a champion?

Team leaders, deputy and registered managers, practice leads and experienced carers who other staff already turn to, and who will be in post for the year ahead.

How many champions?

Up to 12 in a cohort, so every champion gets coached. Larger services can run a second cohort.

Do champions need NVR Essentials first?

It helps, and in the full programme they do it with their teams. Champions who missed it start with the NVR Toolkit before the first block.

What happens after the programme?

Each champion has a 90-day plan, runs a session for their own team with us observing the first one, and joins a network with champions from other services.

Where does NVR come from?

Non-violent resistance was developed by Haim Omer to help parents respond to aggression without escalating it. We have adapted it for children's homes, fostering and family support, and every session pairs it with lived experience of care.

How is it priced?

Every service is different, so we quote for your numbers of staff and champions. Tell us about your service and we'll come back to you within 3 working days.



Luke Rodgers BEM
Founder and CEO, The Care Leaders

Your facilitator

from care leaver to care leader.

Luke went into care at 10. At 15 he was living in a bed and breakfast, and at 18 in a caravan. He gave his first keynote at 19 and has spent his career since inside children's services, as a consultant, trainer, board member and national engagement lead.

He has built non-violent resistance into children's homes with Durham County Council: two online modules and two face-to-face workshops for every residential worker, timed around shift patterns, reaching over 120 staff across 11 homes. He also led the consultation behind Durham Cares, the council's commitment to less restraint and stronger relationships.

Every NVR session he designs pairs Haim Omer's approach with lived experience of care, so staff hear what the hot moment feels like from the young person's side as well as their own.

He founded The Care Leaders in 2017, and it has since worked with 36 local authorities and national bodies, including the Department for Education and the NHS.

- **Gold, Dual Perspective Leadership Award**
  iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026

- **British Empire Medal**
  2018, for commitment to children and families

- **Knowledge Equity Fellow**
  Saïd Business School, University of Oxford, 2020 to 2021

- **Social Entrepreneur Fellow**
  School for Social Entrepreneurs, 2015 to 2017

The CareLeaders TCL nvr

Getting started

four steps to your first cohort.

1 Get in touch

Tell us about your service, your staff and roughly how many champions you have in mind.

2 Have an initial call

We reply within 3 working days to book a call about your homes, your rotas and your dates.

3 We provide a quote

A clear price for your numbers of staff and champions, and what is included.

4 We start with a health-check

Your seven-pillar health-check and NVR Essentials dates come first.

hello@thecareleaders.com

What we need from you

- A named lead and an executive sponsor
- Time protected for staff, with cover, so they can attend
- Champions who will be in post for the year ahead
- A room for face-to-face days, or Teams or Zoom with cameras on
- One real case per champion to work on through the programme
- Agreement on how you will show impact

Commissioned by your council or service. Contact us for a price.

iese Awards GOLD Winner 2026 The Public Sector Transformation Awards

Children & Young People Now Awards 2023 Winner

Gold, Dual Perspective Leadership Award, iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026.
Children & Young People Now Workforce Development Award 2023.

The Care Leaders Ltd, company number 10782615 · October 2026